Army of Roaches

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Army of Roaches

by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

After being startled first thing in the morning, Catra and Adora find themselves fighting a cockroach in order to recover their room…

Notes

Well, this is gonna sounds super weird but, fr, this happened to me. Like, all you're gonna read. The tweets I put as inspiration for this prove it. Oh, and I think I didn't tweet the little issue with which this ends, but that part also happened…

Anyways, I hope you enjoy and have some fun reading these shenanigans. I wrote five fics using this event, for different fandoms, that is, and this is one with quite a soft couple, I believe.

I'll leave links to the other fics in the ending note.
Now please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by My tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)
- Inspired by Second tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)
- Inspired by Third tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)

As the sun rose over Bright Moon, its light filled the room where Adora and Catra slept soundly. Being so comfortable in each other's arms, neither wanted to wake up. But Melog seemed determined to make that happen, and kept meowing non-stop.

—Come on, Melog. A few more minutes— Catra groaned. But it was useless and the meowing continued. Adora moved to get up but she held her tightly, protesting —No, no, stay a bit longer, please…

—Melog is right— she replied, until a yawn interrupted her. —Let's get up so we have enough time to have breakfast without rushing.

—Fine— Catra grumbled. Once she pushed herself up, the meowing stopped and she was tempted to fall back on bed, until she noticed Melog was staring intently at her legs. She brushed her eyes and finally saw it. —A-Adora!

—Wha- Hey!

Catra had literally jumped off the bed and right into her arms staring at the same place as Melog.

There was a roach on the bed.

—It-It walked over my leg, it-it was next to my leg!

—Don't worry, I got this— Adora replied, with such a cocky tone that it was obvious to Catra what she planned to do.

—Hey, no! You can't just go full She-Ra on it! You'll trash the bed!

Disheartened, Adora lowered her arm.

—Oh, right… Then, I can go ask if someone can help us with that bug— she suggested.

—Bu-but don't take long.

Adora left, giggling at how both Melog and Catra stared at the roach with laser focus, as if fearing it would disappear the moment they looked away. She returned a few minutes later with a small bottle.

—I was told I have to open this in the room and close everything for a few hours— Adora explained, trying to get Catra's attention to no avail. —Hey, let's just go. This poison will kill the roach and we can then return when it's dead.

—Are you sure that will kill it?

—Yeah, I was told this is quite a strong thing. We have a few minutes to leave as soon as I open it because it starts evaporating to release the poison— Adora explained, seemingly scared of the bottle she was holding.

—Woah. Alright. Melog! Let's go!

Adora went for some spare sheets to "close" the windows, as much as possible, and then set the bottle in the middle of the room, uncorked it, and ran out, closing the door behind her.

The rest of their day went on as usual as they fulfilled different tasks, helping with the rebuilding of several villages across Etheria, and returned quite late. They arrived at the room, bantering and laughing, despite Adora looking ready to drop on the spot.

—… well, but I'm She-Ra. They had me lift and move whole batches of resources all day.

—Yeah, and I ran errands between four different villages and didn't break a sweat— Catra countered, smirking. —Admit it! I can still beat you— she claimed, triumphantly.

—Fine, whatever. You always play dirty though— Adora reproached, smiling fondly.

They both laughed together for a moment before Adora opened the door. She entered, covering her nose because of the nasty smell, and quickly removed the sheets from the windows to ventilate the room.

—This smells awful— Catra complained, backtracking. Her sense of smell was perhaps too sensitive and could barely stand the strength of the lingering poison. —Can we go have dinner now?

—Yeah, of course! I only wanted to open everything so we can then go to sleep without, you know, being intoxicated— Adora laughed, leaving the room without closing the door.

She put her arm around Catra's shoulders, and they both headed to the dining room. The subject was entirely avoided during dinner as they didn't want to tell Glimmer there were roaches in *her* palace. Finally, by the time they returned to their room, Adora almost asleep, the place was habitable again.

—Can you…— Adora began, but was interrupted by a yawn —Please make the bed? I'm really tired.

Catra rolled her eyes as she replied —Sure, I'll just- Erm… where's the roach?

She began looking around: it wasn't on the bed anymore, and it couldn't be seen anywhere on the floor from where she stood; it simply wasn't there. Before she could move further to keep looking, an idea froze her in place.

And if it was still alive!?

—What's… the problem, Love?— Adora asked, yawning again.

—I-I can't find the roach. Wha-what if it didn't die?

—You smelled that— she replied, once again interrupted by a yawn. —It's surely dead. We can… find it tomorrow. Just change the sheets, I really need to sleep. And you won't get me to… make bed instead.

Adora continued to yawn, barely able to keep her eyes open now, but Catra was tense with fear, and so was Melog; she had grabbed her tail, kept nervously stroking it, and shook her head repeatedly.

—It's not that. I-I just can't sleep here. What if it walks over me again!?

—Catra, that's…—, "ridiculous" she was about to say, but interrupted herself. Noticing her distress, she instead suggested —Perhaps… we could sleep outside for tonight? We haven't yet… enjoyed the new stars.

When she looked back at Adora, she had a really tired expression but a soft smile that slowly calmed her down. She nodded, headed for the door but stopped right before leaving, noticing Melog wouldn't follow and only meowed at her.

—Reclaim… territory?— Catra repeated. She laughed and nodded. —As you prefer.

She finally grabbed Adora by the hand and they soon arrived at a secluded grassy garden where they could lie down together. They stared at the stars until sleep claimed them.

The next morning, Adora woke up with the sun in her eyes and a group of Bright Moon's guards staring at her and Catra. It immediately set off an alarm in her head, but she soon recalled they were, in fact, sleeping at an unusual place without having told anyone.

The guards, confused, had even called their general so, moments later, they were both awake and trying, very awkwardly, to explain to her what happened. They finally settled for arguing they just wanted to sleep under the starry sky.

After breakfast, they went through their tasks for the day; Adora's assignments were far more than Catra's so she begged her to deal with the roach before nightfall because she'd arrive even more tired than the previous night and certainly needed to sleep on a comfortable bed this time.

She agonized all day.

While Melog was sitting in bed since the previous night, Catra kept tentatively walking into the room, only to backtrack within minutes, always expecting the roach to come running at her suddenly. Every time she returned to the door and groaned in frustration, Melog would meow at her, confused.

—You don't fear roaches? Great! Then why don't *you* look for it instead of making fun of me!?— she replied, annoyed. —No, no! I don't want to ask for help. It's just… it's a bug, not like anyone would care. Why can't you do it?— she insisted. Melog stared for a moment

before looking away seemingly offended. Catra looked away too, crossing her arms, and let out —We said we wouldn't tell Glimmer. So no, I won't ask her for help. But it's not- I'm *not* ashamed.

The rest of the afternoon continued that way and, by nightfall, the room still wasn't ready for them to sleep. Adora arrived so tired she almost walked into the closed door and it took her a few minutes to realize the room was exactly as they had left it the night before. Catra had been too hesitant to get help from anyone, and too afraid to, at least, remove the bedsheets.

Queen Glimmer was walking down the corridor, amicably chatting with Bow about dinner, when they heard Adora's groaning and what sounded like an afraid Catra. Moments later, they found one completely drained, laying against the wall, while the other kept nervously pacing back and forth, her sight always on the door, and arms crossed in front of her chest.

—Um… guys?— Bow called out.

Adora yawned before replying —Don't worry, it's nothing…

—It doesn't sound like "nothing"— Glimmer insisted.

Catra halted and looked sideways at her, shyly. Both the Queen and Bow noticed and waited patiently until she spoke up.

—It's just… we have a tiny issue… with a bug— she tentatively explained.

—Oh, wait. Since yesterday?— Bow asked. Adora nodded and he exchanged a glance with Glimmer. —That's why you were sleeping in the gardens, right?

Catra looked away, a bit ashamed but smirking, and admitted —Yeah…

—You could have told us!— Glimmer laughed. —Do you want me to help you?

—No…

—Yes! Please!— Adora interrupted. Catra gave her a look of betrayal, but she felt so tired she could only reply —Sorry, I had to.

Glimmer giggled and entered the room. Moments later, she was out, smiling with satisfaction.

—Done. I totally obliterated it with a spell, you have nothing to worry about, Catra.

—I wasn't worried! I-I just- they are disgusting! I can't even see them— she argued, shivering at the end.

Both Bow and Glimmer found it somewhat endearing but preferred not to say anything, especially since Bow had the exact same issue.

—Well, the room is roach free now. You can get your bed back tonight— he assured her.

They finally had a good night's sleep and woke up perfectly rested. They began their morning early and after breakfast, they checked their tasks for the day. This time, it was Catra who had a loaded day, while Adora merely had to run two errands and then had the rest of the day free.

After the last two days dealing with the roach incident, Adora decided to clean up the room herself, because Catra had only changed the bedsheets the previous night. She wanted to make sure no more roaches would give them a bad time so, by the time Catra was back, the place was tidy and clean. They both had dinner with Glimmer and Bow, joking about how the family of the roach is now planning to avenge it, and laughed during the whole meal, imagining how the war against the Horde would have been, had they all been roaches instead.

Hours later, when they were all finally in bed, Adora was trying to sleep but a scratching sound kept waking her up.

After the third time, she called out —Stop it, Melog…—. The sound stopped and she closed her eyes only to be awakened a few minutes later by the same sound. —Melog!

This time, Catra woke up, a bit groggy, and told Adora —Melog is sleeping, you know.

—What!? Then who's doing that sound?

—What sound, Adora? I don't hear anything— she grumbled with her eyes closed again.

They kept silent for a moment, waiting for the sound, and when it seemed like it had been her imagination, there it was again. Adora got up from bed, lit up the room, and tried to pinpoint where the sound came from. Catra, on the other hand, was still brushing off her sleepiness, and hadn't noticed Melog sitting right in front of a closet, staring at the top of it.

—I can't guess where it's coming from— Adora complained, after hearing it again, and looking in the general direction of the wardrobes.

Catra finally approached them, looked at Melog, and asked —What is it, buddy?—. The mowing she got as a reply completely froze her in place. Adora looked back at her and noticed her puffed tail and her scared expression. With her voice strained, she stammered —There are- There… are ma-many more- more roaches… up there. In the-the top half o-of the closet!

Before Adora could reply, they heard the scratching sound again and now couldn't help imagining the bugs in there moving and making that sound. But even if those weren't roaches, they didn't really have any more options.

—I'll go get another bottle of insecticide, alright? Can you grab our clothes in the meantime? And a blanket. We could go to the gardens again…

—No, no, no, no. I'm out— she uttered, right before sprinting out of the room.

—Catra! Wait!— Adora exclaimed, concerned once again, and followed her outside. Melog was walking in circles around her, worriedly meowing; her disgust made her shiver and her tail kept swaying back and forth. —Catra, are you…

—How many roaches *are there*!? I- is this really revenge!? What are we…

—Hey, hey— Adora interrupted, placing her hands on her shoulders. She smiled gently at her, wanting to ease her tension, but Catra was so scared thinking there could potentially be more roaches than they imagined, that it seemed like she just wanted to set the room on fire. —We'll solve this like last time, Love. Please calm down.

Catra took a deep breath, holding her hands together tightly, and finally nodded. Relieved, Adora wrapped her in a tight embrace, until some footsteps called their attention.

—Why are you guys making such a scandal?— Glimmer asked, rubbing her left eye, and barely holding back a yawn.

—I- We're sorry, Glimmer. It's just that we have… more roaches— Adora replied, apologetically.

—More? Ugh— she groaned. —That room needs urgent cleaning— she sighed.

—I was about to go get some more of the stuff they gave me the other day. Could you stay with her while I'm gone?

—Yeah, don't worry. I'll stay.

Once Adora left, Catra sat down against the wall and Glimmer went to sit between her and Melog. She stayed silent, waiting until she's ready to talk.

—I can't believe this is happening— she finally let out. —Where are they coming from? The Universe hates me!

Glimmer laughed at that before noticing her distressed expression, and instead replied — That's not true. Bugs are pretty normal, you know? This many indoors isn't that normal, but it's definitely not your fault. We just need to get the room fully cleaned soon.

—I-I guess…— she sighed. —Thank you, Sparkles.

—Come on, Catra— she insisted, nudging her side playfully. —You don't need to worry about this anymore tonight. We can just have a sleepover!— the Queen suggested, wanting to cheer her up. —You know… the first night Adora spent here, we had a sleepover because she couldn't stand sleeping alone. I guess she missed having you at her feet.

Catra finally smiled, her tension slowly receding, and Glimmer felt Melog's head rest on her leg. She was calming down.

Moments later, Adora announced —I'm back!

She had a small vial of insecticide, just like what she used the first time, but just enough for the top of the wardrobe. While she handled placing the poison up there, Glimmer grabbed their clothes along with some blankets and joined Catra outside, calling for her and Melog to follow her. Within minutes, they had arrived at the Queen's room where Bow was ready to go to sleep.

—Oh, hi, Catra. Did anything happen?

Both replied —Roaches.

Bow stared for a moment before asking —Are you telling me that roach's family was *really* planning vengeance!?

Glimmer cackled at first, genuinely amused, but when she thought about it, her laugh became nervous.

—It's just a coincidence, Bow. You guys have nothing to fear. It's not like there's an army of roaches out there— she assured them. —I said I'll have the room cleaned, so forget that for tonight. We all need sleep, and I thought we could have a sleepover!

—Oh! That's a great idea! We haven't had sleepovers in so long!— he immediately exclaimed. —But! We can make it better.

—*Better*? We just want to sleep— Catra replied, tired already and most probably still feeling guilty.

—You guys had the best idea the other night— he replied. —We should have a sleepover under the stars!

His excitement quickly overtook them all. The three of them gathered some blankets and pillows, left Catra and Adora's clothes neatly folded on a chair, and departed for the gardens.

On their way, they came across Adora, and Catra briefly explained —We're having a sleepover, but at the garden where we slept the other night.

—Where we were found early in the morning? Where we had to explain what we were doing to the Royal Guard? I don't think you'll want to repeat that.

—It was *his* idea! If anything goes wrong, it's on Arrow Boy— Catra laughed.

—Hey!

His indignant exclamation made Glimmer and Adora stifle a giggle. In turn, their amusement flustered him.

—Don’t worry, guys. That won’t happen this time, not with me there— Glimmer finally said, confident.

—I bet that won’t be enough— Catra dared her.

—You’re on, Horde Scum— the Queen replied, looking back at her defiantly. —If I win, you’ll have to clean that wardrobe yourself.

Catra shivered but didn’t back down, and immediately countered —But if *I* win, then you’ll have the palace staff clean our room while we rest.

—Oh, deal!— Glimmer accepted, shaking her hand.

Bow and Adora witnessed their challenge and easily noticed this was very entertaining for them and that they were actually enjoying betting against each other. It resembled their old animosity, but now under a light of friendship that entirely changed things.

Morning arrived soon enough to prove Catra right.

The four of them had been awakened by the arrival of curious soldiers, but this time, it was Glimmer herself who dealt with them. However, a deal is a deal, and now both Catra and Adora were free of cleaning duty and could comfortably rest while the palace staff entirely swept their room.

They had the day free this time, so they decided to go out on a date; they’d have their room ready when they went back, meaning they could even have dinner before returning, and go straight to sleep.

It was a much-needed leisure day.

The next day, around noon, Glimmer was walking down the hall and happened to come across their room. The door was open so she looked inside and found both Adora and Catra staring at the ceiling.

A chunk of it had fallen to the floor. White material was spread right before their feet, and over their heads, there was a considerable hole that served as a warning of the poor state the ceiling material was in.

The Queen stared for a moment too, before finally saying —That’s it. I’m temporarily moving you two to a spare room.

Upon hearing that, Adora immediately snapped out of her shock and exclaimed —Great! We’re sleeping in prison now!

She laughed at her own joke, and Glimmer couldn’t hold back a snort.

—I promise we *didn't* remove any cushions!

They both cackled again, barely able to control themselves, and almost out of breath. Meanwhile, Catra stared at them, blinking in utter confusion, entirely oblivious to what they could be talking about.

—Erm… what?

Adora made an effort to breathe properly and managed to calm down. She wrapped an arm around Catra and walked out with her.

—Oh, come with me, I'll tell you about it. In retrospect, what happened was extremely funny — Adora laughed.

End Notes

Yes. A piece of my ceiling fell down.
Also, everything Melog does here is what my cat did. ~~But she's not a magical alien~~ Oh, she also meowed trying to tell me about the ceiling, but I forgot that part, oops!

Now, I hope you had fun and, in case you wanna read the other versions of this, if you like the other fandoms, here are the links:

Honkai Impact 3rd: Duranrita version
Genshin Impact: Jeanlisa version
She-Ra (2018): Glimbow version, Castaweaver version

Thank you all for reading!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!